

CCNA Christmas Roadmap (10 hrs/week pace)

ccna-christmas-
roadmap.md

Drafted with ChatGPT on August 30, 2025. Executed through December 2025. Content is verbatim from the original chat; only the formatting was cleaned up for publishing.

17 September (Now → Sept 30)

- **Goal:** Build momentum & set habits.
- ☒ Finish ~25–30% of Jeremy's IT Lab (~35–40 videos).
- ☒ Daily Anki (spaced repetition is what locks subnetting/MAC/CLI facts).
- ☒ Packet Tracer: practice basic CLI (hostname, IP, enable secret, show/run/startup).

17 October (Oct 1 → Oct 31)

- **Goal:** Get through the bulk of the content.
- ☒ Reach 65–70% complete (~80–85 videos).
- ☒ Focus weeks on switching, VLANs, routing basics (RIP, OSPF), ACLs — heavy exam areas.
- ☒ Labs: inter-VLAN routing, static routes, ACL practice.
- ☒ Anki daily review (don't let cards pile up).

Checkpoint test: Take a light practice exam (free online or Packet Tracer challenge). Don't worry about score — just measure what feels "foreign."

17 November (Nov 1 → Nov 30)

- **Goal:** Finish content + move into review.
- ☒ Wrap up all 126 videos (~100% complete).
- ☒ Start Boson ExSim practice exams (these are gold).
- ☒ Redo tricky labs cold (routing tables, ACLs, NAT, trunking).
- ☒ Identify weak topics → rewatch Jeremy's targeted videos, drill Anki.

Checkpoint test: By mid-November, aim to hit 60–70% on Boson exams. By end of Nov, push into the 80s.

- **Goal:** Sharpen + lock in.
-  Daily rhythm: 1 Boson exam, then 2–3 hrs targeted review of what you missed.
-  Mix in Packet Tracer “lab sprints” (rebuild a topology from scratch under time pressure).
-  Final week: Review Anki + cheat sheets only. Keep it light.

Exam window: Mid-late December → sit for CCNA. If you follow this plan, you’ll go in battle-tested.

Gotchas to Watch

- If CS6035 gets heavy → don’t pause CCNA completely. Even just Anki + 1 lab keeps momentum alive.
- Don’t delay Boson until the very end — use it by November so you’re fixing weak spots early.
- Scheduling: book your exam 4–6 weeks ahead (slots fill near holidays).

TL;DR

- End of Sept → ~35–40 videos done.
- End of Oct → ~80–85 videos done.
- End of Nov → all content done + Boson practice in 60–70%+ range.
- Mid-Dec → ready for the real exam.